Barber Republic

A platform that fills empty chairs: independent barbers matched to shops that need cover, paid fairly, on the day.

Built by Velocity AI (Mainly Velocity Ltd) with the Barber Barber team. London pilot planned.

HOW TO READ THIS DRAFT. Boxed notes with dashed lines mark gaps or items needing a decision. Nothing here is released until the confidentiality note is signed and Shane has agreed what is shared. Planning figures are scenarios, not agreed terms or a valuation. Delete the boxed notes and slide 7 before anything leaves the building.

Sources: Phase One MVP Development Agreement (17 Aug 2026), The Money Model (Aug 2026), Capital and Exit Pathways (13 Oct 2026), Reuzel letter of intent (2 Nov 2026). All internal.

An empty chair is an expensive day

- A shop with an empty Saturday chair loses an estimated five to seven hundred pounds in takings (Johnny's trade read, Money Model).
- Shop owners are slow to pay for systems; about 25 to 35 pounds a month is what a shop will carry today (Johnny's conversations with the trade).
- Barbers will not pay to be on a staffing platform. The Republic pays them; it never charges them for existing.

GAP. No market size (number of UK shops and barbers) and no customer evidence beyond Johnny's own conversations. Needs a sourced figure and 5 to 10 named or anonymised shop quotes. The three questions to the trade (would you pay 30 pounds to save a 600 pound Saturday?) have not yet been asked.

Four layers, switched on in order

Layer	What it is	Opening dial
1 Commission on the covered day	The shop pays when the chair is filled and the day is done; urgency carries a premium	10% standard, 18% urgent, 22% VIP house call
2 Technology fee	A flat charge per booked day that funds the matching	1 to 2 pounds per day
3 Membership	Shops only; later an intelligence subscription (what a chair should cost, who is reliable)	25 to 35 pounds a month; barbers 0
4 Scale layers	Coaching, credential, corporate venues, brand partnerships. Priced later	Not priced

Layers 1 and 2 carry the pilot. The AI is the engine inside the product (matching, ranking, voice and text handling), not the product itself.

GAP. All percentages and fees are opening dials, to be settled with the trade. No product screens or demo included. Insert 4 to 6 screens from the MVP once Phase One completes. Operating cost: the supplier example is about 474 to 542 pounds a month for 50 shops and 200 paid bookings; a full monthly total is not yet substantiated (Operating Economics Review, 12 Oct).

Source: The Money Model (Aug 2026); Operating Economics Review (12 Oct 2026). Planning dials, not agreed prices.

Built, backed in principle, not yet proven in the market

- **Product:** the MVP is nearing the end of Phase One (build by Velocity AI under the agreement of 17 Aug 2026).
- **Operator base:** the Barber Barber business and its network, with Johnny's standing in the trade.
- **Support signal:** a non-binding letter of intent from Reuzel (2 Nov 2026), offering support, not capital.
- **Investor map:** 112 UK B2B investors that did a pre-seed to Series A deal in 2025 and 2026 (Wahoo Services map); fit not yet checked.

GAP, and the honest one. No paid jobs, no live users, no pilot metrics yet. Investors will ask for completed paid jobs, repeat shops and barbers, and cost to serve. That evidence only exists after the pilot. Letters of intent from other trade names would help. Do not describe the Reuzel letter as investment.

Sources: Phase One MVP Development Agreement; Reuzel letter (2 Nov 2026); Wahoo Services map.

Funding stages: what each stage pays for

Stage	Pays for	Planning amounts (three routes)
Pre-seed (next)	Production readiness, tests with the trade, a paid local pilot	300,000 / 600,000 / 1,000,000 pounds
Seed	A second cluster; acquisition and support costs established	1m / 2m / 3m
Series A	Scale the strongest clusters	3m / 6m / 10m

Route 1 (focused marketplace) is the leanest: 300,000 pounds over about 15 months, about 17,000 pounds a month for all spending.

DECISION NEEDED (Shane). Which route and what size. Imran is said to think the raise should be "much bigger", which is Shane's view too. Valuation, equity offered and use-of-funds budget are not agreed. Do not show equity percentages or implied valuations until agreed.

Source: Capital and Exit Pathways, 13 Oct 2026. Planning scenarios, not a valuation, offer or agreed terms.

Who is behind it

- Johnny Shanahan and Morgan Leahy, 50/50 owners of BarberBarber Ltd; StayTrue Ltd also involved.
- Builder: Mainly Velocity Ltd (trades as Velocity AI), with Shane McCarthy and John Webb O'Rourke as commercial and technical leads.

GAP. Short bios for each person. Which legal entity will take the investment and hold the IP, to be confirmed with Shane. Do not state IP ownership, payment status of the build, or any balance owed until Shane has agreed the wording. Counterparty entity names to confirm.

Source: Phase One MVP Development Agreement (17 Aug 2026), as summarised in Cuan records.

What happens after a first conversation

- Confidentiality note signed before any figures are shared.
- Complete the MVP and run the London pilot to produce four facts: fill rate, margin on a covered day, rebooking rate, and whether the engine works beyond barbering.
- Prepare a fuller deck with product screens, pilot data and a financial model.

GAP. No dates. A pilot start date and a deck completion date need Shane and Johnny.

Will this meet what the market expects?

Honest answer: not yet. This works as a concept note to open a conversation. It is not an investor-ready deck. General market practice (not verified against a source) is that early investors expect:

- A sourced market size and a clear customer
- A product demo or screens
- Traction: paid jobs, users, repeat rate
- Unit economics and a 3 to 5 year model
- A named team with bios
- A cap table, ask and use of funds
- Competitors and why we win

Where we stand against that:

- Have: the model, planning scenarios, a trade signal, an investor map
- Missing: traction, demo screens, model, bios, agreed ask
- AI angle: it is a marketplace using AI, not an AI company. Say so plainly

Suggested handling: take it to the meeting on Tuesday and talk it through, rather than sending it. Nothing sent before the confidentiality note and a background check on Imran Rahim.